Chrysler Valiant Chrysler Centura (Australia) Specification & Service Reference - Page 1/2

AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Chrysler Valiant | Model: Chrysler Centura | Australian Market Years: 1975-1978
Vehicle Type: 4-door Sedan | Segment: Mid-size | Locally Built: Yes
Assembly Plants (AU): Tonsley Park, Adelaide, South Australia

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The Chrysler Centura (KB and KC series) was Chrysler Australia's audacious weapon to conquer th e mid-size family car market dominated by the Holden Torana and Ford Cortina. Assembled at Tons ley Park in Adelaide, Chrysler imported European Simca 180 bodyshells from France and undertook radical local re-engineering to shoehorn Chrysler Australia's mighty Australian-cast 3.5L (Hem i 215) and 4.0L (Hemi 245) pushrod straight-six engines, alongside a French 2.0L Simca 4-cylind er. With 123 kW (165 hp) and 319 Nm of torque propelling a compact 1,200 kg body, the Hemi 245 Centura was an astonishing sleeper muscle sedan, sprinting from 0-100 km/h in under 9 seconds a nd completing the standing quarter-mile in 16.5 seconds. 19,770 units were produced across the KB (1975-1977) and updated KC (1977-1978).

The Centura's Australian introduction was famously sabotaged by history: in 1973, French union wharf bans in protest of French atmospheric nuclear testing in the South Pacific delayed import ed Simca bodyshell shipments for over twelve months. Unassembled bodyshells weathered on Adelai de wharves before assembly commenced in 1975. Despite this, Australian performance drivers love d the car's sensational straight-line speed, and it enjoyed a formidable track career in produc tion car rallying and circuit racing.

SERIES / GENERATION: KB (KB Centura) [1975-1977]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan | ANCAP: None
First Centura series. Modified front sheetmetal, heavy-duty front crossmember, MacPherson strut suspension, and Australian Hemi 215 and 245 straight-six engines.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Simca-Type-315-2.0L: 2.0L (1981cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 71.0 kW / 152.0 Nm
- Hemi-215-I6: 3.5L (3523cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 104.0 kW / 283.0 Nm
- Hemi-245-I6: 4.0L (4014cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 123.0 kW / 319.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Centura GL 245: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, 4-speed manual floor Borg-Warner, 3-spee
- Centura GLX 245: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual floor Borg-Warner, 3-speed automatic Borg-Warne

Factory Configurations:

* Centura GLX 245 | Sedan | Hemi-245-I6 | 4-speed manual floor Borg-Warner | RWD | 123.0kW/319.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: KC (KC Centura) [1977-1978]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan | ANCAP: None
Facelifted front grille with Chrysler pentastar, improved sound insulation, revised suspension geometry, and ADR27A anti-pollution updates.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Hemi-245-I6-ADR27A: 4.0L (4014cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 104.0 kW / 305.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Centura GL 245: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual floor, 3-speed automatic, AUD $5190-$5790, Fuel=

Factory Configurations:

* Centura GL 245 | Sedan | Hemi-245-I6-ADR27A | 4-speed manual floor | RWD | 104.0kW/305.0Nm